Chapter 4
Social Behaviour and Artificial Intelligence:
The Myth of Sisyphus in Question

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ABSTRACT

Social behavior is central to the rise of artificial intelligence (AI). This chapter studies the global internet network as a repository of data that companies and governments use as a valuable commercial and geopolitical tool. But in the face of this optimistic vision of global information management, society must ensure freedom and privacy in the community. The denunciation of abuses and the need to set ethical and political limits to the use of AI in relation to social behavior and its contexts is today a priority task, nor do we want to fall into a dystopian society. The border between freedom and AI is marked by ethics.

INTRODUCTION

Social behaviour begins with language, but its channels continue to multiply throughout the development of our species. The rise of artificial intelligence (AI) is making more complex a panorama that itself it is already. The global Internet network is a colossal data repository that companies and governments use as a valuable tool, but in the face of this optimistic vision of global management, the canon of society has appeared since its inception: to ensure freedom in community. Privacy is a guiding element of the political structure and the exponential growth of information channels could put it at risk. It is not about recovering a past of denial of technological progress or predicting a dystopian future, but it is about denouncing abuses and setting ethical and political limits to the use of AI in relation to social behaviour and its contexts (Saura, Ribeiro-Soriano y Palacios-Marqués, 2021a).

These limits are given spontaneously and unpredictably by us, apart from any regulation. Human behaviour in stressful situations is capable of outsmarting AI in its predictions, we have very recent and clarifying cases in this regard that puts into question the successes of automation. Algorithms are nourished by our activity and social networks, are they capable of predicting what may interest us or

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rather what we frequent or make us frequent? Social behaviour in times of crisis dislocates AI and its patterns, no matter how much the human footprint is digitized and ready to be evaluated as a consumer, user or in the political game, for example. The ability of AI does not penetrate human emotion, but it does penetrate the faculty of manipulation. From the smart phone onwards, computing transforms information and can even exceed human capacity in certain competitions. But is man condemned to repetition or does he act in a more unpredictable way?

The original challenge is to study the fine line that separates dependence from independence, repetition from freedom. The added value of the study is, precisely, to approach AI from a purely ethical and social reflection perspective.

THE BORDER BETWEEN FREEDOM AND AI

Human freedom is one of the universals inherited from the Enlightenment. High modernity has bequeathed to late modernity that we live a host of political, social or communication experiences that today are questioned by the extraordinary rise of the means of knowledge control. If Hobbes sacrificed freedom for security (2008), while Locke set himself up as the antecedent of liberalism (2010), today both are in danger. It is no longer a controversy or cultural struggle between freedom and security, if we want between individual and community, but between truth and lies, reflection or perpetuation, autonomy or manipulation by selection and repetition.

AI is a technological resource whose depository mind is human, we mean that it reproduces what it received. The data entered is done by human hands based on registered social behaviours. But these behaviours, in turn, reproduce, transmit and bias behaviours. Knowledge about society and its consumption habits or information margin is biased by itself, by everything quantitative that it is possible to collect, study and process. Is it possible, perhaps, the social transformation or that of knowledge from these premises, or is it an eternal loop that feeds itself without apparent end?

The term “Artificial Intelligence” (AI) is applied when a machine mimics the cognitive functions that humans associate with other human minds, such as learning or solving problems (Russell & Norvig, 2009). The human being makes decisions based on the information that he collects from the outside through the senses. The brain from the birth of the person is processing that information, shaping the personality of the individual, accumulating memory information and all this serves in the decision-making process. In contrast, AI tries to imitate that human behaviour, and systems such as neural networks and machine learning systems have been developed so that the machine itself makes those decisions. AI works using large amounts of data with fast, iterative processing and intelligent algorithms, allowing software to automatically learn from patterns or characteristics in the data.

Russell & Norvig propose how four approaches have been followed based, on the one hand, on the mental process and reasoning, and on the other, on behaviour.

Systems that think like humans. An effort to make computers think, like machines with minds, in the strict sense (Haugeland, 1985). The automation of activities that we link with human thought processes, such as the aforementioned key decision-making or problem solving and learning processes (Bellman, 1978).

Systems that act like humans. The development of machines with the capacity to perform functions that when performed by people require intelligence (Kurzweil, 1990). Or following Rich & Knight, the study of how to get computers to perform tasks that humans do better, for the moment (1991).

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